

GOOD HEARTH
A solar heater, rain water harvesting or thermally insulated windows are the invisible home upgrades that make all the difference

Start Small at the Tap

Begin at the tap, the smallest thing in your house that you touch every day. A water-saving aerator is a mesh fitting that screws onto the tap you already have. It mixes air into the water, so the pressure feels the same while you use far less of it. A few hundred rupees, two minutes and it works in a flat or a house. If you do nothing else after reading the article, do this.

Shielding Your Windows

Once you have seen how little it takes, look at your windows and do it before the summer, not during it. In a flat you cannot touch the roof, but the roof is not always the real culprit. West-facing glass is. Sunlight pours through it all afternoon and turns the room into an oven by evening. A thermal insulation film blocks much of that heat while still letting light through, and your air conditioner finally gets to rest.

Cooling Down Roofs and Walls

If the roof happens to be yours, it is worth waiting for—not because it is difficult, but because it is best done when the terrace is due for work anyway. Cool roof coatings reflect sunlight instead of letting the slab soak it up all day, and a good one brings the temperature inside down by a few degrees. The same logic applies to your walls. There is no reason to repaint one that does not need it, but the day you



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